

Hadrosaurids

Also known as “duck-billed” dinosaurs, the hadrosaurids were large plant-eaters with distinctive, ducklike bills that they used to clip leaves from plants. Hadrosaurids may have lived in large herds, and some types seem to have formed nesting colonies in which parents nursed their young after hatching.

Maiasaura

MY-a-SORE-a



- **When** 80–74 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Coastal plains
- **Length** 30 ft (9 m)
- **Diet** Leaves

The name *Maiasaura* means “good mother lizard.” In Montana, scientists found numerous bowl-shaped *Maiasaura* nests close together. The site may have been a nesting colony where parents raised their young, like nesting colonies of modern seabirds.

▲ **FAMILY LIFE** Fossilized eggshell pieces and young *Maiasaura* were discovered in nests in Montana. The presence of young animals suggests that hatchlings stayed in the nest while being looked after, just as many baby birds do, rather than leaving immediately as newly hatched turtles and crocodiles do.



FAMILY FACT FILE

Key features

- Ducklike bills
- Rear of mouth was packed with thousands of teeth for grinding leaves
- Forelimbs were half as long as hindlimbs
- Many hadrosaurids had strangely shaped crests on their heads

When

Hadrosaurids lived in the Cretaceous Period, between 100 and 65 million years ago.